

RIVERVIEW-MILL DISTRICT

Mobility & Connectivity Plan

A complete streets, employment access, rail-trail and placemaking strategy for the fictional City of Lakehaven, New York.

01

CONNECT TO JOBS

02

BUILD A LOW-STRESS NETWORK

03

LINK PARKS + TRANSIT

04

MAKE STREETS PLACES



A visual roadmap of the district strategy and implementation sequence.

- 01 Executive Summary
- 02 Neighborhood + Mobility Context
- 03 Existing Transportation Conditions
- 04 Employment Access Strategy
- 05 Complete Streets + Crossings
- 06 Foundry Rail-Trail Greenway
- 07 Parks + Placemaking
- 08 Transit + First/Last Mile
- 09 Implementation + Funding
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- 11 Conclusion + Technical Basis



A connected network for everyday opportunity.



THE PLAN IN BRIEF

The Riverview-Mill District Mobility & Connectivity Plan is a fictional planning exercise demonstrating how a neighborhood transportation strategy can connect residents to jobs, transit, parks and daily needs without requiring a private automobile. The district is close to major destinations, but long crossings, incomplete bicycle facilities, uneven transit access, an inactive rail corridor and winter maintenance gaps make short trips difficult or unreliable.

The recommended network combines a complete-street transformation on Maple Avenue, a 2.4-mile Foundry rail-trail greenway, safer crossings, first- and last-mile transit improvements, park connections and public-realm investments. Each recommendation addresses a different point in the same trip, so the plan emphasizes continuity rather than isolated projects.

Implementation is phased so quick-build safety work and design can begin before larger capital projects. Physical improvements are paired with transit operations, winter maintenance and employer coordination. Performance measures track employment access, low-stress network proximity, accessible-route continuity and resident-reported crossing comfort.

ACCESS
Connect homes to jobs, transit, parks and services.

SAFETY
Reduce crossing exposure and create a low-stress network.

RELIABILITY
Make non-auto trips work across shifts and seasons.

Close to opportunity, but separated by transportation barriers.



RESIDENTS

8,600

MEDIAN HOUSEHOLD INCOME

\$34,800

HOUSEHOLDS WITHOUT A VEHICLE

31%

BELOW POVERTY LEVEL

28%

RESIDENTS WITH A DISABILITY

16%

Three major employment areas are assumed within three to six miles: HarborWorks Industrial District, Northgate Medical and Education Campus, and Lakehaven Center. The distances are manageable, but the network does not consistently support safe or convenient non-auto travel. Long crossings, missing bicycle links, inconsistent transit access, shift timing, winter conditions and the inactive rail corridor create friction at multiple points in a single trip. The planning challenge is not simply distance. It is continuity.

Where the network breaks down and why those gaps matter.



AUTO-ORIENTED CORRIDOR
Wide roadways, high vehicle speeds and limited bicycle facilities create an uncomfortable environment for non-auto travel.



INACTIVE RAIL BARRIER
The inactive rail corridor is a physical and psychological barrier, separating neighborhoods from jobs, transit and parks.

01 LONG CROSSINGS

Wide roadway geometry increases exposure.

02 TRAIL GAP

Inactive rail corridor interrupts connectivity.

03 LIGHTING GAP

Low visibility reduces comfort after dark.

04 TRANSIT ACCESS

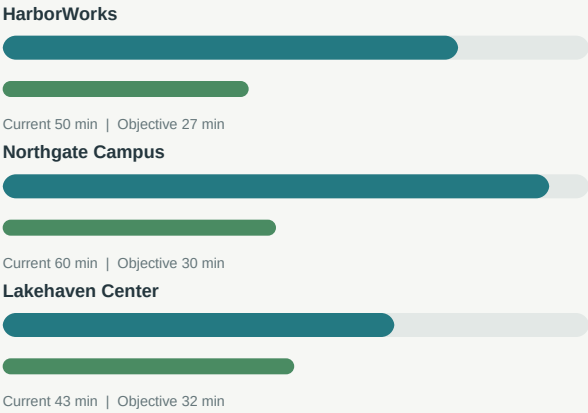
Stop access is inconsistent and indirect.

Employment Access Strategy

Design the network around destinations, travel time and work schedules.



ILLUSTRATIVE NON-AUTO TRAVEL TIME



Complete Streets Corridor

Maple Avenue becomes the neighborhood multimodal main street.



Illustrative concept only. Final dimensions require traffic, transit, drainage, curb-use, emergency-access and ADA analysis.

The concept reallocates street space to reduce crossing distance, create a protected low-stress bicycle connection and introduce planted buffers that support shade and stormwater management. Final dimensions would be refined through traffic, turning, drainage, transit, curb-use, emergency-access and accessibility analysis.

Shorter crossings, clearer priority and safer conflict points.



SHORTEN EXPOSURE

Curb extensions and refuge islands reduce crossing distance.

MAKE PEOPLE VISIBLE

High-visibility markings and lighting improve conspicuity.

SEPARATE CONFLICTS

Signal timing and leading pedestrian intervals clarify priority.

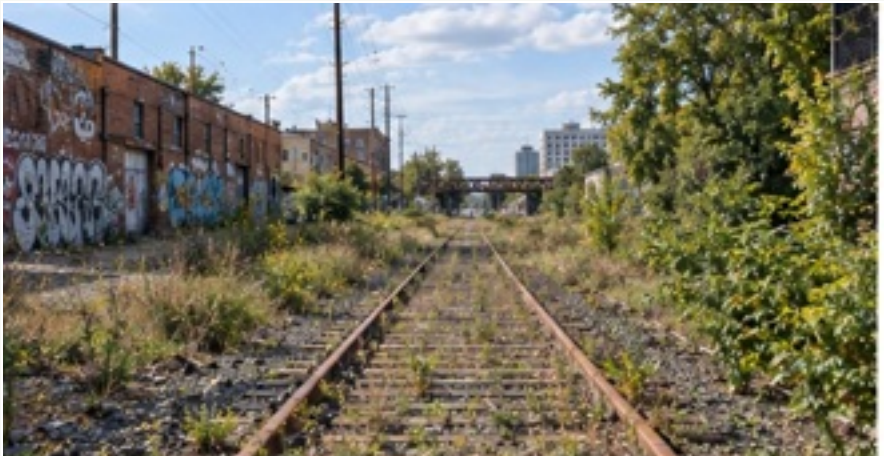
VERIFY OPERATIONS

Final treatments depend on speed, volume, transit and warrants.

09

Foundry Rail-Trail Greenway

Turn a barrier into a low-stress transportation spine.



BEFORE | INACTIVE RAIL CORRIDOR



AFTER | GREENWAY TRANSPORTATION SPINE

GREENWAY

2.4 MI

PREFERRED PAVED WIDTH

12 FT

PRIMARY TRAILHEADS

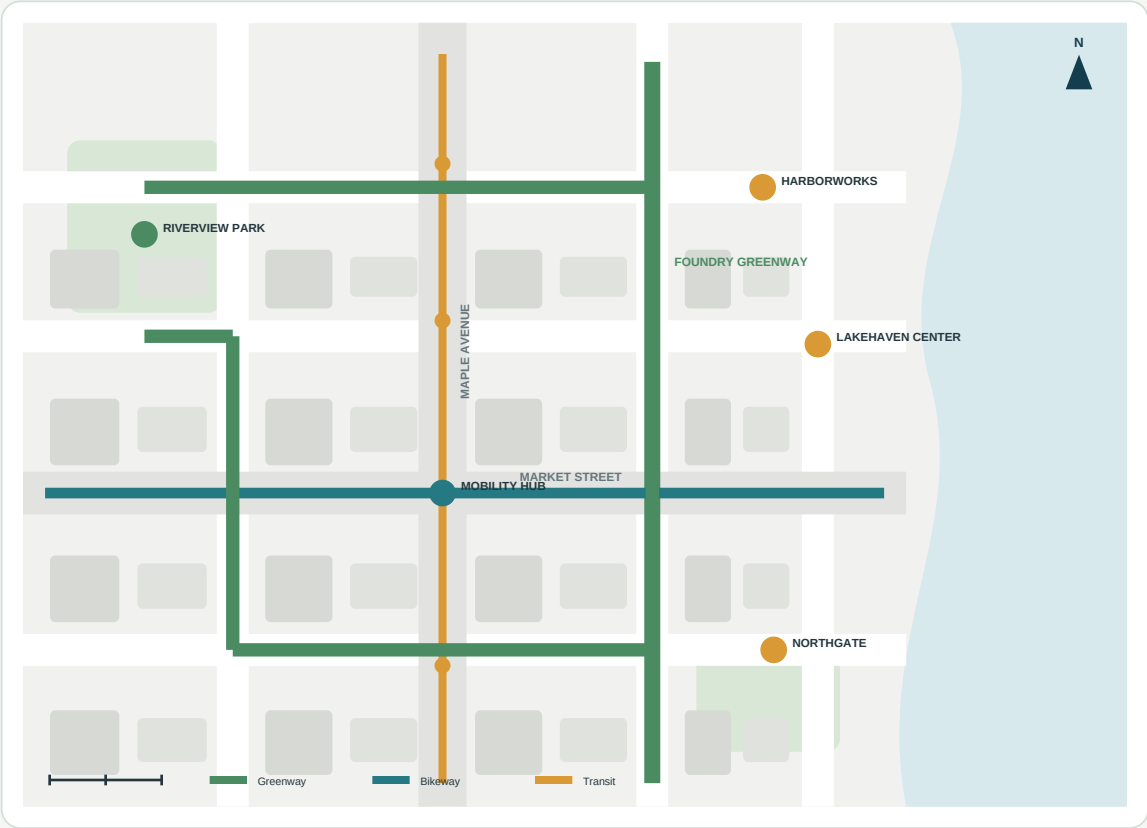
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LOW-STRESS CONNECTION

ALL AGES

The Foundry Greenway is treated as transportation infrastructure, not only recreation. It creates a continuous, legible route between Riverview Park, Maple Avenue, Market Street, HarborWorks and the regional trail system. Trailheads should connect directly to sidewalks, transit stops and bicycle facilities, with lighting, wayfinding, accessible grades and winter maintenance standards established during design.

Connect recreation, neighborhood identity and everyday mobility.



MOBILITY AND PLACE

Parks, trailheads and commercial streets become mobility anchors when safe crossings, shade, seating, lighting and wayfinding are designed as part of the network.

PLACEMAKING TOOLKIT

Gateways, public art, pedestrian-scale lighting, trees, seating and green infrastructure reinforce identity without substituting aesthetics for safety engineering.

The rider experience begins before the bus arrives.



Define snow-clearance responsibility for stops and curb ramps.

FREQUENCY

Coordinate key trips with shift starts and ends.

A COMPLETE TRANSIT TRIP

- 1

WALK / ROLL
Continuous accessible route
- 2

CROSS
Safe, visible crossing
- 3

WAIT
Shelter, seating + lighting
- 4

RIDE
Service aligned to shifts

EMPLOYER PARTNERS

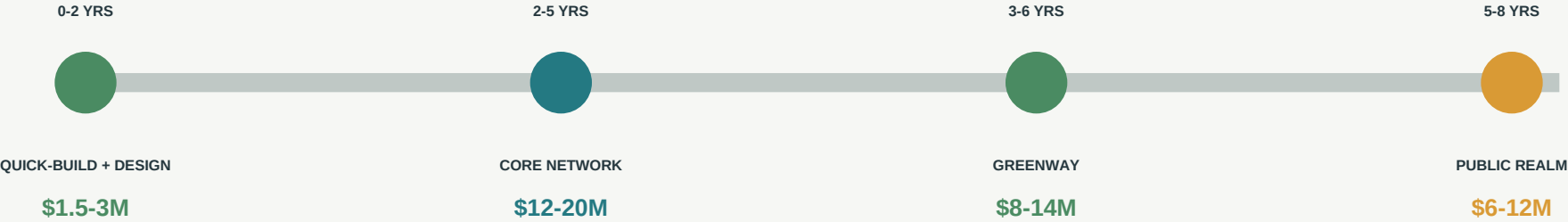
Pass programs, bike parking and guaranteed ride home.

MOBILITY HUB

Shelter, seating, information and bike parking.

Move from vision to visible change in coordinated phases.

PHASED DELIVERY



The plan uses a coordinated funding stack rather than waiting for one grant to fund every component. Safety, transit, trail, accessibility, green infrastructure and placemaking elements can advance on different schedules while reinforcing the same corridor vision. Early design and quick-build work can position larger projects for competitive state and federal programs.

CROSSINGS

HSIP + local

PROTECTED BIKEWAY

TA + STBG

RAIL-TRAIL

TA + local

MOBILITY HUB

FTA 5307 + local

Measure outcomes and connect them to an implementation checklist.

EMPLOYMENT ACCESS

One job hub within 30 min

75%

LOW-STRESS ACCESS

Within 1/4 mile of network

90%

PRIORITY ROUTES

Continuous accessible routes

100%

CROSSING COMFORT

Resident-reported improvement

+30 pts

ID	PROJECT	PHASE	KEY DEPENDENCY	LEAD
CS-1	Maple road diet	2	Traffic + turning analysis	City/consultant
CS-2	Raised protected bikeway	2	Cross-section + drainage	City/consultant
PX-1	Five priority crossings	1-2	Engineering study	City
TR-1	Maple/Market mobility hub	1-2	Stop siting + accessible design	Transit agency
TR-2	Employment shift service review	1	Ridership + shift data	Transit/employers
RT-1	Rail-trail feasibility/design	1	Title + environmental review	City/partners
RT-2	Rail-trail construction	2-3	Site control + design	City/partners
PK-1	Riverview Park connector	2	Crossing design	City

A connected strategy grounded in established transportation planning guidance.



FROM BARRIERS TO CONNECTIONS

The Riverview-Mill strategy is intentionally organized as a network rather than a collection of isolated projects. Safer crossings, a redesigned Maple Avenue, the Foundry Greenway, improved transit access and stronger park connections each solve a different part of the same trip. Their value increases when implemented together.

The plan also demonstrates an implementation approach that can move from near-term safety work to larger capital investments without losing the overall vision. Quick-build crossings, design studies, service coordination and maintenance agreements can begin early while the City advances feasibility, engineering and funding for complete-street and greenway projects.

The central measure of success is practical: residents should be able to leave home, move safely through the neighborhood, reach transit or a low-stress bicycle route, arrive at work or a park reliably, and return after dark with confidence. By closing the gaps that interrupt that trip, Lakehaven can turn transportation from a barrier into a platform for access, health, neighborhood vitality and economic opportunity.

TECHNICAL BASIS

FHWA Road Diet Informational Guide | FHWA Proven Safety Countermeasures | FHWA Separated Bike Lane Guide | U.S. Access Board PROWAG | FTA Section 5307 | Transportation Alternatives | NACTO Urban Street Design Guide